

STUDENT SAFETY POLICY

Rationale

Anchored in the University's vision, mission, and core values, the Student Safety Policy reflects the institution's unwavering commitment to safeguarding the welfare of its students. The University recognizes that ensuring students' physical, emotional, and psychological well-being is a moral, legal, and professional responsibility. Every learner has the fundamental right to feel safe, respected, and protected within the academic environment.

This policy serves as a comprehensive guide for preventing, addressing, and mitigating various risks that students may encounter, such as physical accidents, bullying, harassment, mental health challenges, online threats, and other similar situations - both within and beyond the campus. Through this policy, UM affirms its dedication to creating a secure, supportive, and inclusive learning environment for all.

Scope

The scope of this policy covers all students enrolled at varied programs of all colleges at UM, wherein students undergo on-site or off-campus activities and events organized by the institution. This policy also extends to the teaching and non-teaching employees who are responsible for student supervision or involved in student-related activities.

Guiding Principles

Student-Centered Safety. All students have the right to learn, grow, and participate in activities in a safe, secure environment. The safety, best interest in mind and the wellbeing of students are paramount in every initiated activity/event in the institution.

Proactive Prevention. The University prioritizes the identification and mitigation of accidents, incidents, and risks before they escalate into harm by integrating safety planning into academic and extracurricular activities.

Respect and Protection. Every student must be treated with respect and dignity, ensuring protection from physical, emotional, psychological, and online threats.

Inclusive and Equitable Access. Safety measures and support services shall be accessible to all students, regardless of gender, age, ethnicity, religion, disability, or socioeconomic status.

Transparency and Accountability. Processes related to safety concerns, reporting, and resolution shall be clearly communicated, fairly implemented, and regularly monitored to maintain trust and responsibility.

Collaborative Engagement. The University promotes shared responsibility for safety by actively involving students, faculty, staff, and external stakeholders in planning, reporting, and responding to safety issues.

Compliance

In adherence to CMO No. 9, series of 2013, and CMO No. 8, series of 2021, all student-led activities and events must comply with the institutional Code of Conduct as outlined in the Student Handbook. Students are expected to observe all relevant safety requirements and follow established reporting procedures to the management. The conduct of these activities shall be guided by applicable statutory laws and regulatory policies to ensure their efficient and effective implementation. Sanctions and penalties shall be imposed on students found in violation of these policies, following due process as part of the institution's disciplinary procedures.

Implementation and Review

To effectively implement the Student Safety Policy, the University shall conduct regular risk assessments across all areas of student engagement, including within school premises, field trips, vehicle use, and special events. Safety training for staff and students will be mandatory, covering emergency response, online safety, and incident reporting. Emergency drills (e.g., fire, earthquake, evacuation) shall be routinely practiced, with clear signage posted campus-wide. Adult supervision shall be required during all academic and extracurricular activities, both on and off campus. Infrastructure and safety systems, such as access controls, surveillance, first aid kits, and transport services, will be regularly maintained. Also, a confidential and accessible reporting mechanism shall also be in place to ensure timely response to safety concerns.

This policy shall be reviewed annually or as necessary, particularly following serious incidents. The Office of Student Affairs (OSA) shall lead the review, in coordination with the Quality Management Office. Feedback from students, staff, and stakeholders will inform proposed revisions. Final updates shall be approved by the University Management and formally communicated before taking effect.

Signed:

(Sgd) GUILLERMO P. TORRES, JR.
University President

Reference

Student Handbook, 2024 (Section 1, Item 1.2, pp. 5-14)